

largest native tribe in North America, the majority of whom live in Arizona.

The Papago and Pima are closely-related tribes that are believed to be descendants of the Hohokan, a prehistoric people who constructed an elaborate system of irrigation canals. Both tribes excel at farming, and the women weave exceptionally beautiful baskets. Today, both the Papago and the Pima live in Arizona.

The Zuni were among the first pueblo-dwellers to suffer from Spanish greed. Spanish explorers mistook the yellow walls of their adobe homes for gold, prompting a report to the Spanish viceroy that the “fabled Seven Cities of Cibola, whose streets were paved with gold” had been discovered. This resulted in Coronado and his armed adventurers invading in search in the reported gold. The Zuni fled to the top of an inaccessible mesa where they built a single, defensible village. They live there to this day.

Other southwestern tribes include the Mojave, Tewa, Tiwa, and the Yuma.

## Far West

The tribes of the Far West are those of Montana, Oregon, Washington, Colorado, California, and Utah. They have varied cultures, but are not usually numbered among the Plains tribes or those who lived along the coast of the Pacific Northwest.

The Flatheads were a Salishan tribe in Montana who adopted the Plains Indian culture with the arrival of the horse, and traded in bison and beaver skins. Plains tribes gave them their unusual name to distinguish them from other Salish tribes, who shaped the front of their heads to create a pointed appearance.

The Miwok were a central Californian tribe who gathered nuts, fished, and hunted deer and rabbits. Before the Gold Rush, the Miwok were a rich and prosperous culture, but today they are nearly extinct.

The Modoc are native to southwestern Oregon and are most remembered for their fierce resistance to being forced onto reservations. After much bloodshed, part of the tribe was relocated to Oklahoma, while the rest were left in Oregon.

The Nez Percés, which means “pierced noses,” customarily wore pieces of dentalium shell through their septums. They were semi-nomadic and were best known for their trading skills, bravery, and generosity. Their fine basket weaving and breeding of Appaloosa horses brought them fame as well. Unjustly driven from their lands, they now live in Idaho.

And finally, the Utes were from Colorado and western Utah, and shared many cultural traits with the more northern Plains tribes. Today, they raise cattle and live on reservations.

## Far North and Pacific Northwest

The native peoples of this region are either coastal dwellers or live in the far frozen north. All of these tribes derive much of their livelihood from fishing and hunting, and must cope with the cold, harsh winters of the north.

The Aleuts and, more commonly, the Inuit are familiarly called Eskimos, “those who eat their food raw.” For the most

part, the Aleuts reside on the Aleutian Islands. They are adept at hunting and harvesting resources from the sea in their skin-covered kayaks. They suffered greatly from exploitation at the hands of Russians traders who came to the islands in the mid-18th century. The Inuit are big game hunters, surviving mostly on seal, walrus, caribou, and polar bear. They still utilize igloos. On land they use dog sleds, while on water they use kayaks and umiaks. They are found throughout the Arctic, Alaska, and Northern Canada.

The Chinook live in Washington state and their trade jargon became the common language used throughout the Northwest; the words *potlach* and *hooch* are derived from their language. Incursions by European trading companies broke their trade monopoly by introducing diseases that decimated the tribe.

The Haida live on the Haida Gwaii (formerly known as the Queen Charlotte Islands) off the coast of British Columbia. Once hunters of whales and sea otters, they traveled in huge canoes hollowed out of enormous cedar trees. They were known for their masks, totem poles, and decorations on their wooden houses. Contact with the Europeans was devastating to the Haida, and they fell victim to smallpox and venereal disease. The Kwakiutl lived nearby on Vancouver Island. They too were famous for their totem poles and decorations, especially the carved prows on their huge canoes. Culturally related to both the Haida and the Kwakiutl are the Tsimshain — artistic carvers and weavers of Chilkat blankets. Their original home was in British Columbia, but in 1884, a clergyman of the Church of England persuaded them to move to Alaska.

The Lummi are a Salishan tribe of northwestern Washington. The main form of sustenance is salmon, and many of their ceremonies revolve around salmon and fishing. They once fought annual ceremonial battles with the Haida for the purpose of capturing slaves. These encounters are still honored with a yearly warrior ceremony, which includes canoe racing and dancing.

## Camps

Camps are the Nunnehi equivalent of the courts of the Kithain. Seelie and Unseelie mean nothing to the Nunnehi, instead they belong to Winter (also known as Rock), Summer (Dogwood), or Midseason (Laurel) Camps.

While the Kithain often conceal their court, especially if they are Unseelie, the Nunnehi wear their camps on their sleeves, often quite literally. One can often tell quite easily if a Nunnehi is of the Winter, Summer, or Midseason Camp by examining her clothing, accessories, and demeanor.

A Winter person often dresses in dark colors of warfare or mourning. Her face and body may be painted with the colors and symbols of the wrong that has been done to her and she will seldom smile or be friendly, except perhaps with another of the Winter Camp. Dressing and acting in this manner is considered fair warning, by Nunnehi, for any who would dare cross her. A Nunnehi of the Summer Camp tends to dress in warm and bright colors. He may wear face and body paint as well, but of cheerful and welcoming design, intended to delight